

Email Migration Plan

Moving White Box Studio email from BOX / cPanel to Google Workspace

ADDRESSES MOVING

info@white-box.co.il
daphna@white-box.co.il

HANDS-ON TIME

About 2 hours
spread over 2–3 weeks

RISK

Low, if you follow
the order of steps

Start here: the reassuring part

Your website will not change at all. Not one line. Your domain stays `white-box.co.il`, your email addresses stay exactly the same, and the 7 places `info@white-box.co.il` appears in the site's code stay exactly as they are. This migration changes only *where your mail is delivered*.

Your contact form does not send through the cPanel mail server, so nothing below can break the form itself. One nuance: the form posts to a service called Web3Forms, which emails a notification to *both* `info@` and `daphna@`. That notification is delivered **to** the two mailboxes you are migrating — so it follows your MX record like any other incoming mail, and works normally once mail is at Google. Step 7 has you test exactly this.

⚠ WHY THIS MIGRATION MATTERS MORE THAN IT LOOKS

A reverse lookup of the mail server `148.251.82.238` returns `cp57.box.co.il`. Your mail host is **BOX** — the provider you already left because it was terrible. The websites moved; the email never followed, and has been sitting there ever since. That is the most likely reason it "fails or disconnects often." This is not a new decision — it is finishing one you already made.

THE ONE RULE

The order of the ten steps *is* the safety mechanism. Your old mail gets copied across **while email is still flowing normally to cPanel**. By the time you flip the switch, nothing is at risk — and everything stays reversible until the very last step.

The five words you need to understand

TERM	WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEANS
DNS	The phone book of the internet. It translates <code>white-box.co.il</code> into the address of an actual computer. Yours is managed at Netlify .
MX record	The line in the phone book that says “ <i>send this domain's email to this server.</i> ” This is the switch you are flipping.
SPF	A public note saying “ <i>only these servers may send email as me.</i> ” Stops others forging your address, and keeps your mail out of spam folders.
DKIM	An invisible signature on every email you send, proving it really came from you and was not tampered with.
DMARC	Your instruction to other mail servers about what to do when an email <i>fails</i> the SPF and DKIM checks.
TTL	“Time To Live” — how long the world may remember an old answer before asking again. Lower means your changes take effect faster.

Where you will be clicking

Two websites, and it is worth being clear which is which, because it is easy to get lost:

- **Netlify** — `app.netlify.com` → **Domains** → `white-box.co.il` → **DNS records**. Every DNS change below happens here. Your DNS lives at Netlify even though your email does not.
- **Google Admin** — `admin.google.com`. Where you create mailboxes and get your DKIM key.

You will never log into cPanel again, except to check old mail and — at the very end — to cancel it.

Your DNS records: before and after

This table is the whole migration. Everything else in this document is just how to get there safely.

RECORD	RIGHT NOW	AFTER MIGRATION
MX	<code>mail.white-box.co.il</code> priority <code>0</code>	<code>smtp.google.com</code> priority <code>1</code>
SPF (a TXT record)	<code>v=spf1 +a +mx +ip4:148.251.82.238 ~all</code>	<code>v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all</code>
DKIM (TXT, <code>google._domainkey</code>)	<i>does not exist</i>	a long key Google gives you
DMARC (TXT, <code>_dmarc</code>)	<i>does not exist</i>	<code>v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:daphna@white-box.co.il</code>

The `148.251.82.238` in your current SPF is the BOX server (`cp57.box.co.il`) that cPanel runs on. That is the thing you are leaving behind.

The order of operations

Read this list before doing anything.

- 1 Lower the TTL — a day ahead, so the switch happens fast
- 2 Sign up for Google Workspace and verify you own the domain
- 3 Create your mailboxes
- 4 **Copy all your old mail across** — while email still flows to cPanel
- 5 Flip the MX record — *this is the actual switch*
- 6 Fix the SPF record
- 7 Test thoroughly
- 8 Run the mail copy one final time, to catch the gap
- 9 Add DKIM and DMARC
- 10 Wait two weeks, then cancel cPanel

1 Lower the TTL — do this the day before

Why: TTL is how long the internet caches the old answer. Yours is probably 1 hour. Lower it to 5 minutes *first*, and tomorrow's switch takes effect in 5 minutes instead of an hour. A small step that removes a lot of anxiety later.

1. Netlify → Domains → `white-box.co.il` → DNS records
2. Find the **MX** record pointing at `mail.white-box.co.il`
3. Edit it and change **TTL** to `300` (300 seconds = 5 minutes)
4. Save. **Change nothing else.**

Then wait a day before Step 5. You can do Steps 2–4 during that wait.

2 Sign up and verify the domain

Go to `workspace.google.com` and sign up for **Business Starter**.

- When it asks for your domain, enter `white-box.co.il`
- Make your first account `daphna@white-box.co.il` — see Step 3 for why

Google then asks you to prove you own the domain, usually by adding a TXT record.

POSSIBLE SHORTCUT

Your site already carries a Google Search Console verification tag. Google sometimes recognises this and skips verification entirely. If it offers, take it.

If you do need to add the record:

1. Netlify → DNS records → **Add new record**
2. **Type:** TXT
3. **Name:** leave empty. Netlify may show this as `@` or as the bare domain — all three mean “the domain itself”
4. **Value:** paste exactly what Google gives you (it starts with `google-site-verification=`)
5. Save, then click verify in Google. Usually works within minutes.

⚠ DO NOT TIDY UP

You now have **two** TXT records on the domain — your existing SPF, and this new verification one. **That is correct and expected.** Do not delete the SPF one to “make room.” Multiple TXT records are completely normal.

3 Create your mailboxes — and save money

You have two addresses, but you probably only need **one paid account**.

- `daphna@white-box.co.il` — your real user account. This is the one you pay for.
- `info@white-box.co.il` — add as an **alias** on that same account.

An alias is free. Mail to `info@` lands in the same inbox, and you can still *send* as `info@` when you want to appear as the studio rather than yourself. That is roughly **27 ILS per month instead of 54**.

To set it up: Admin → Directory → Users → click your account → **User information** → **Email aliases** → add `info`.

Only make `info@` a separate paid account if someone *other than you* needs their own private login for it.

4 Copy your old mail across — the important one

Do this while email is still being delivered to cPanel. You are copying, not moving. Nothing is deleted from cPanel, so there is no way to lose anything at this step.

Google Admin → **Data migration**. If you cannot find it, type “data migration” into the admin search bar.

SETTING	VALUE
Migration source	Other IMAP server (may appear as “IMAP” or “Generic IMAP”)
Server	<code>mail.white-box.co.il</code>
Port	<code>993</code> , with SSL enabled
Username / password	your existing cPanel mailbox credentials

Run it for both `info@` and `daphna@` if they are separate mailboxes on cPanel today.

Depending on how many years of mail you have, this takes anywhere from minutes to several hours. Let it finish. Then **open Gmail and actually look** — confirm old messages are really there and folders came across — before going anywhere near Step 5.

Port 993 was verified as open and reachable on your mail server, so this connection should work.

5 Flip the MX record — the actual switch

This is the moment new mail starts going to Google. With TTL at 300, it takes about 5 minutes.

1. Netlify → DNS records
2. **Delete** the existing MX record — `mail.white-box.co.il`, priority `0`
3. **Add new record**, with these values:

```
Type: MX
Name: (leave empty – the domain itself)
Value: smtp.google.com
Priority: 1
TTL: 300
```

That single record is all Google needs — they simplified this in 2023. If you find an older guide listing five `ASPMX.L.GOOGLE.COM` records, that is the legacy setup. It still works, but you do not need it.

TIMING

Do this on a **weekday morning**, not a Friday afternoon — so if anything looks wrong, you have the whole day to sort it out.

6 Fix the SPF record

Do this straight after the MX change. If you skip it, mail you send from Gmail may land in recipients' spam folders.

1. Netlify → DNS records → find the TXT record whose value starts with `v=spf1`
2. **Edit it**. Do not add a second one — see the mistakes section
3. Replace the value with:

```
v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ip4:148.251.82.238 ~all
```

This temporarily authorises **both** Google and your old server, which is the safe choice while both still exist.

Later, once cPanel is cancelled in Step 10, simplify it to:

```
v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all
```

7 Test

Do not skip this, and do not test in only one direction.

- ☐ Send an email **from** Gmail **to** your personal Gmail or other address — it arrives, and is **not** in spam

- ☐ Send an email **from** that outside address **to** `info@white-box.co.il` — it arrives in Gmail
- ☐ Repeat the incoming test for `daphna@white-box.co.il`
- ☐ Submit the contact form on `white-box.co.il` and confirm the notification still reaches you
- ☐ Reply to a message and confirm the reply sends

You can check the DNS side at `mxtoolbox.com` — enter `white-box.co.il`, and MX should show `smtp.google.com`.

8 Run the migration once more

Between your Step 4 copy and the Step 5 switch, a few emails may have landed on cPanel. Re-run the same Data Migration from Step 4. It skips everything already copied and picks up only the stragglers.

9 Add DKIM and DMARC

These are not strictly required for mail to work, but they are what keeps you out of spam folders long term. Do them a few days after everything else is stable.

DKIM

1. Google Admin → **Apps** → **Google Workspace** → **Gmail** → **Authenticate email**
2. Click **Generate new record** — use 2048-bit
3. Google shows you a **name** (`google._domainkey`) and a very long **value**
4. In Netlify: Add new record → Type **TXT** → Name `google._domainkey` → Value: the long string, pasted exactly
5. Wait about 15 minutes, return to Google, click **Start authentication**

Copy that long value carefully. A single missing character breaks it silently.

DMARC

Add one more TXT record in Netlify:

Name: `_dmarc`

Value: `v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:daphna@white-box.co.il`

`p=none` means “**monitor only, block nothing.**” This is deliberate: you get reports with zero risk of legitimate mail being rejected. Only consider tightening to `p=quarantine` after months of clean reports, and there is no urgency at all.

⚠ NEVER DO THIS

Do not start with `p=reject`. It can silently destroy real email.

10 Cancel cPanel

Wait a full two weeks after Step 7 passes. Not two days. You want certainty that nothing was missed — including monthly senders such as invoices, or suppliers who email you only occasionally.

Once you are confident:

1. Do one last check of the cPanel webmail for anything unexpected
2. Simplify SPF to `v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all` — drop the old server's IP
3. Raise TTLs back to `3600`. You no longer need fast changes
4. Cancel the cPanel account

THE BONUS

Those “AutoSSL reduced coverage” warning emails stop **forever**. That whole problem existed only because the cPanel server was trying to manage certificates for a website it does not host. Once mail leaves, the account has no reason to exist.

Four mistakes that break email

Worth reading twice.

1. **Two SPF records.** You must have **exactly one** TXT record starting with `v=spf1`. Two is worse than none — mail servers see the conflict and fail the check entirely. In Step 6, *edit* the existing record. Never add a second.
2. **Deleting the wrong TXT record.** After Step 2 you will have several TXT records on the domain: SPF, Google verification, and later DKIM and DMARC. They coexist happily. Deleting one to tidy up breaks whatever depended on it.
3. **Switching MX before copying mail.** Flip MX first and new mail arrives in an empty Google mailbox while your history sits stranded on a server you are about to cancel. Copy first. Always.
4. **Cancelling cPanel too early.** A few more weeks of hosting fees is *nothing* compared to discovering in October that a client's email from September went to a server that no longer exists.

If something goes wrong

You can always undo the switch. Nothing here is permanent until you cancel cPanel in Step 10 — which is exactly why Step 10 is last.

To roll back: in Netlify, delete the `smtp.google.com` MX record and re-create the original one. With TTL at 300, mail flows back to cPanel within about 5 minutes, exactly as before.

ROLLBACK MX RECORD — KEEP THIS WHERE YOU CAN FIND IT

mail.white-box.co.il priority 0

Quick reference card

Keep this page beside you while you work. It contains every value you need to type.

WHITE BOX STUDIO — DNS

FINAL STATE, AT NETLIFY

MX	(name empty)	smtp.google.com	priority 1
TXT	(name empty)	v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all	
TXT	google._domainkey	v=DKIM1; k=rsa; p=... (from Google)	
TXT	_dmarc	v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:daphna@white-box.co.il	

DURING THE OVERLAP (STEP 6, TEMPORARY)

TXT	(name empty)	v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ip4:148.251.82.238 ~all	
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ROLLBACK, IF NEEDED

MX	(name empty)	mail.white-box.co.il	priority 0
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OLD SERVER — WHAT YOU ARE LEAVING BEHIND

Hetzner / cPanel	148.251.82.238
IMAP, for the migration	mail.white-box.co.il : 993 (SSL)

WHERE TO CLICK

DNS changes	app.netlify.com Domains > white-box.co.il > DNS records
Mailboxes, DKIM	admin.google.com
Check your work	mxtoolbox.com

IF ANYTHING GOES WRONG, THIS ONE RECORD UNDOES EVERYTHING

MX mail.white-box.co.il priority 0

DNS values in this document were read from the live white-box.co.il zone on 11 August 2026. Google's single-MX recommendation (`smtp.google.com`, priority 1) was confirmed against Google's current documentation the same day. If you are reading this much later, re-check the two Google values before typing them.